



Satish Kumar
CEO
GLOPORE IMS

“At GLOPORE, we avoid taking printouts for internal communication; even most of our outside communication is done through e-mail. At a higher level, we have communicated to our employees to switch off monitors when not in front of the computer; this helps us save electricity. Our systems at the office have LCD screens, which again contributes to saving electricity. We also prefer to give laptops to employees for this reason, besides the advantages of portability.

The monetary savings thanks to such practices aren't much, but we have not set them for monetary gain. It is our contribution to the society and the environment.

Other companies can replicate our conservation methods, and I think even minor changes in policy can bring about a huge difference.

We don't face any difficulty in enforcing these policies—employee awareness works well, and once employees develop these habits—such as switching off monitors and so on—they continue to implement them at home, too.

GOING GREEN



Vimal Khanna
General Manager (India)
NetXen

“We understand that conservation of electricity is important, and to reduce power consumption, we are moving to newer server systems. These new servers don't just consume less power; they easily handle the load of three older servers.

Employees have also been asked to switch off computers when leaving the office. We have separate air conditioning for each department, so if there are no employees in a section, the AC can be switched off.

It is quite feasible for businesses similar to ours to adopt policies like the ones we have. I believe small steps towards conservation by each organisation will make a huge impact on the environment.

I don't think the government should enforce policies for environment-friendly computing, but they should make recommendations.

It is not difficult to change the mindset of employees because they understand the implications of wastage.



Dr Y V Verma
Director - HR & MS
LGEIL

“At LG, our vision is to reduce energy costs by 20 per cent every year. We have set our ACs to run at 24 degrees Celsius, the “green temperature,” and this reduces electricity consumption. Wherever possible, we use natural lighting. There is a team to ensure that employees switch off all lights, ACs, laptops, and PCs. If they leave any devices on, a reminder note is put on their desks as well as on their team head's desk. At the factory, we have double-glazed windows that allow for maximum natural lighting. LG has also installed a solar water heater with a capacity of 5,000 litres. To reduce the running cost per day, we have brought about various innovations in the factory that have reduced resource intake by 50 - 70 per cent. A rainwater harvesting system has been installed for efficient use of water.

Other organisations should implement similar steps. It isn't just environment-friendly, it indirectly increases the brand image of the company and also motivates employees.

The Government should enforce implementable policies, and for some, they should make suggestions. The Government should also create awareness among industries.

It is difficult to enforce certain policies in the face of resentment—it took us four to five years to get to the stage we are at now.

As told to Prakash Ballakoor (prakash_ballakoor@thinkdigit.com)